



PARAM PRASAD CHARITABLE SOCIETY'S
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INSPIRING PERSONALITY – DR. VIKRAM SARABHAI



Dr. Vikram Sarabhai was born on 12 August 1919 in Ahmedabad, Gujarat. Dr. Vikram A Sarabhai obtained his Tripos (1939) and Ph. D. (1947) in Cosmic Ray Physics from Cambridge University, U.K. He worked with Sir C.V Raman, the Nobel Laureate, at the Indian Institute of Science, Bangalore. On his return from Cambridge, Dr. Sarabhai set up the Physical research Laboratory (PRL), Ahmedabad. He also established the Ahmedabad Textile Industry's Research Association (ATIRA) and the Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Ahmedabad.

Family Details:

- ❖ Vikram Ambalal Sarabhai
- ❖ Born: 12 August 1919 at Ahmedabad
- ❖ S/o Ambalal Sarabhai Sarla Devi
- ❖ Wife: Mrinalini Sarabhai
- ❖ Children: Kartikeya and Mallika
- ❖ Died: 31 December 1971

Biography:

- ❖ Vikram Ambalal Sarabhai was an Indian Physicist.
- ❖ He is considered to be the father of the Indian Space Program.
- ❖ His family was a rich Jain family. His father was an industrialist and has many textile mills in Gujarat.
- ❖ He has eight brothers and sister.
- ❖ In September 1942, Vikram Sarabhai married Mrinalini Sarabhai, a celebrated classical dancer.
- ❖ His daughter Mallika Sarabhai was awarded the Padma Bhushan, India's third highest civilian honor of the year 2010 and his son Kartikeya Sarabhai was awarded the Padma Shri in 2012.

Achievements:

- ❖ The establishment of the Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO) was one of his greatest achievements.
- ❖ He successfully convinced the government of the importance of a space programme for a developing country like India after the Russian Sputnik Launch.
- ❖ Dr. Sarabhai started a project for the fabrication and launch of an Indian Satellite. As a result the first Indian satellite, Aryabhata, was put in orbit in 1975 from a Russian Cosmodrome.

Sarabhai established many institutes which are International Repute:

- ❖ Nehru Foundation for development, Ahmedabad
- ❖ IIM, Ahmedabad
- ❖ Physical Research Laboratory
- ❖ Ahmedabad Textiles Industrial Research Association
- ❖ Blind Men Association
- ❖ Electronics Corporation in India Limited, Hyderabad
- ❖ Uranium Corporation of India Ltd, Bihar

Awards:

- ❖ Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar Award (1962)
- ❖ Padma Bhushan (1966)
- ❖ Padma Vibhushan, Posthumous (after death) (1972)

Distinguished Position:

- ❖ President of the Physics Section, Indian Science Congress (1962)
- ❖ President of the General Conference of the I.A.E.A., Verina (1970)
- ❖ Vice-President, Fourth U.N. Conference on 'Peaceful uses of Atomic Energy' (1971)

